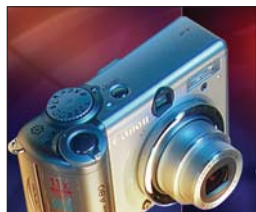




64 Travel with a Mouse-click



70 Digicams: We Test, You Choose



96 Making Sense of Linux

Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Meera Vankipuram

Post the dotcom bust, when all other start-ups were losing their head (and money) and blaming it on bad luck, a few companies decided to stick around and ride the trough.

A few others decided to wait and watch and harness the

In its endeavour to contribute to the Indian IT community, Whizlabs has partnered with companies such as TheServer-side.com, JavaRanch, Certcities, and Addison Wesley.

The Big Idea

Founded in October 2000 by three IIT-Delhi graduates, Purvesh Sharma, Pradeep Chopra and

Kapil Nakra, Whizlabs was born with "initial investments of \$3000 (Rs 1,40,000) contributed by friends, along with a savings of Rs 50,000 coming from our own pockets," says Chopra.

Purvesh, the Operations Director, handles the people management and logistics section of the business. Pradeep serves as the Business Development

Jumpstart

Lessons That Click Right

The incredible story of a Delhi-based company that struck gold with their e-learning tools and services

potential of the Internet to provide Web-based services to individuals and corporates.

One such venture was Delhi-based Whizlabs Software Pvt. Ltd (www.whizlabs.com), whose founders struck upon the idea of offering e-learning tools and services to companies that didn't have the time or resources to help employees upgrade their technical skills.

Whizlabs' services are just the panacea for the 'so-much-to-do, so-little-time' corporate world—especially the IT sector. Whizlabs evolved training modules for exams conducted by leading IT vendors such as Sun, IBM, Oracle, Microsoft, BEA, PMI, Red Hat and Cisco. They also offer "IT Skill Assessment, Employee Evaluation, Recruitment and Certification Exam Preparation Solutions" for corporates".

Having obtained an ISO 9001:2000 certification for their testing methods, Whizlabs claims to have aided the careers of over 4,00,000 people by helping them obtain IT certifications.

Director, while Kapil Nakra, is Director, Sales at Whizlabs.

All three have prior work experience in the Indian software industry, having worked with leading firms such as SAP Labs India and TCS. Says Chopra, "We didn't find much motivation and challenge in a regular software professional's career."

Whizlabs' Services

Whizlabs, which claims to have customers in nearly 90 countries, provides IT skill assessment and certification examination prepa-



Illustration: Anil Deshmukh